



The Little Girl

Title: The Little Girl

About the author- Katherine Mansfield has written this story of a little girl where she has worked on human psychology and written in obliqueness manner. How did the bonding was their between the little girl and her parents, but she was unaware of that, like we generally do.

About the characters-

The little girl Kazia- A tender heart, loving child who is scared of her father, close to her grandmother

The father- A strict person, work oriented busy person, kind at heart, doesn't show any emotions and sentiments, loves and cares for Kazia

The mother- The mother is aloof, strict person, doesn't shares any bond with her daughter, unaware to the fact that when Kazia comes and sits near to her in the drawing room, she is quite weak in health and has to be taken to the hospital eventually

The grandmother- Loving, caring, elder most in the family, wants to create a bond between Kazia and her parents

Alice the maid- An obedient and dedicated house help, polite in nature, looks after Kazia in her mother's absence

Mr. Macdonalds- Next door neighbor, loves his children, plays with his children, speaks politely and doesn't get furious on his kids

Overview-

The little girl is a story that expresses the bond a child shares with his/her parents. The little girl Kazia loves her parents of course but scares of them too. She shares better bond with her grandmother and loves her. She was never able to muster up the courage to sit and talk to her parents. On her mistake, she was scolded by the father in a bad way and her grandmother was the only person who supported her. When her mother was being admitted to the hospital, in her absence Kazia got the chance to understand her father better.

Flow of the story-

1. Kazia feels relieved when her father leaves for his office.

2. She scares of her father.
3. In evening when her father comes back, there used to be the shouts of her father.
4. She keeps standing at a distance.
5. Somewhere, the reader may feel that there is a distance between the parents and the child.
6. On Sunday on grandmother's suggestion Kazia went to drawing room to talk to her parents, but they both are seemingly unapproachable.
7. When Kazia catches cold and kept with grandmother, she tells Kazia that her father's birthday is falling.
8. Kazia decides to make a silk pin cushion for her father.
9. Unaware she is of few important papers of father she filled those in the pin cushion.
10. Her father scolds her very hard.
11. Her mother drags her to the drawing room.
12. Father beats her with a stick on her hand.
13. She hides in her grandmother's lap and hugs her tightly.
14. When she sees the neighbor Mr. Macdonald playing with his kids, she feels her father is very bad but Mr. Macdonald is a good person.
15. Once the mother gets ill and is taken to the hospital.
16. The grandmother too accompanies her.
17. Kazia is looked after by Alice the maid and the father in evening when Alice leaves for her home.
18. Kazia has same old nightmare which she often has- a butcher with a knife and a rope.
19. She screams with fear.
20. She finds her father standing near to her but she asks for her grannie.
21. Her father takes her to his room and makes her sleep in the bed.
22. A funny feeling comes over her that her father is not as bad she thinks of him.
23. He seems a father with a big heart to her.
24. Eventually Kazia finds her father a good person and sleeps on his heart.

Conclusion-

'The little girl' is a story of human emotions. It makes the reader realize that we may think a person as bad we get the impression. Especially, in the case of kids and parents. Sometimes it is difficult for parents to express their love and affection towards their kids. Kids may think that their parents don't love them. Somehow Kazia's father is not as loving as Mr. Macdonald, but she eventually gets to understand that her father cares for her and loves her, and the reader would find this story relatable to their life and situation too.